Recipe 3: Enabling File Streaming and Downloads

With time passing by, we may come across situations wherein users frequently requested to stream and download large media files, such as high-resolution images or documents. With increasing traffic, the need to efficiently deliver these files without hampering server performance became critical. Here, we need to implement an optimized file streaming and download mechanism using Laravel's built-in functionalities. So, you will learn how to implement these functionalities such that our application supports file streaming and downloads for end users.

Laravel's File Streaming and Download Capabilities

The Laravel provides built-in response and **response()->download().** Both of these allow you to serve files directly from the storage with minimal overhead. The **response()->file()** method displays a file inline in the browser. This method reads the file from disk and sends appropriate headers for inline display, ideal for images, PDFs, or media that users view directly in the browser. And, the **response()->download()** method forces the browser to download the file. It sets the **Content-Disposition** header to optionally allowing you to specify a file name and custom headers.